FREE GUIDE · 2026 EDITION

The Austin First-Time Buyer DPA Guide

How eligible Austin buyers are getting $15,000–$40,000 in down payment help — and most have no idea these programs exist.

✓ Current Program Limits · Updated April 2026

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Equal Housing Lender. This guide is for informational purposes only. DPA program availability and income limits are subject to change. Not an offer to lend. Verify current terms at the program administrator's website before applying.

SECTION 1 OF 4

The Myth That's Keeping Austin Buyers on the Sideline

There's one belief that delays more first-time home purchases in Austin than anything else:

> *"I need 20% down before I can buy a house."*

On a $400,000 home, that's $80,000. At $1,000/month saved, that's 6+ years. Buyers who believe this are sitting out the market for years waiting for a number they don't actually need.

The truth: **73% of first-time buyers put down 15% or less** (NAR data). The typical FTB puts down 6–9%. FHA requires just 3.5%. With Down Payment Assistance on top? Some Austin buyers close with as little as $3,000–$5,000 total out of pocket.

73%	3.5%	$0–5K
of FTBs put down 15% or less	FHA minimum down payment	out of pocket for DPA-eligible buyers

This guide breaks down the specific programs available in Austin and Travis County right now — who qualifies, how much help is available, and how it actually works.

How to use this guide: Read Section 2 for the program overview. Then go straight to Section 3 — the "Do I Qualify?" checklist — to see where you stand today.

SECTION 2 OF 4

Austin's Down Payment Assistance Programs (April 2026)

Several programs are currently open and funded for Austin/Travis County buyers.

TSAHC Home Sweet Texas BEST FOR MOST BUYERS

Texas State Affordable Housing Corporation. Available to first-time AND repeat buyers.

Assistance:	**Up to 5% of loan amount**
Type:	**Grant (no repayment, ever) or forgivable 2nd lien**
Income limit:	**Up to $167,250 (Travis County)**
Purchase price limit:	**Up to $593,364 (Travis County)**
Min. credit score:	**620 FICO**
FTB required?	**No — open to all buyers**
Status:	✅ **Open and funded (April 2026)**

On a $350,000 home, the grant option = up to $17,500 you don't have to save. Zero repayment.

TDHCA My First Texas Home

Texas Dept. of Housing and Community Affairs. Can stack with the Texas MCC tax credit.

Assistance:	**Up to 5% of loan amount**
Type:	**0% interest deferred 2nd lien — no monthly payment**
Min. credit score:	**620 (lenders often require 640)**
FTB required?	**Yes (no ownership in last 3 years; veterans exempt)**

Status:	✅ **Open — first-come, first-served**

Stack it with the MCC: get DPA + a 15% annual tax credit on mortgage interest for the life of the loan (~$2,900/year on a $300K loan at 6.5%).

City of Austin Homebuyer Assistance

Assistance:	**Up to $40,000 forgivable (5–10 year term)**
Income limit (family of 4):	**~$78,100**
Geographic limit:	**Austin city limits only**
Status:	✅ **Open**

Best for buyers earning under $78K in Austin proper. Largest assistance amount but tighter income limits.

Travis County Hill Country DPA

Assistance:	**4–6% forgivable (10-year term)**
Income limit:	**Up to $138,460**
Purchase price limit:	**$364,452** ⚠️ **(misses current Austin median)**
Min. credit score:	**640 FICO**
Status:	✅ **Open**

Best for buyers targeting homes under $365K in Travis County suburbs.

Program details as of April 2026. Verify current limits at tsahc.org · welcomehome.tdhca.texas.gov · austintexas.gov · corporations.traviscountytx.gov. Equal Housing Lender.

SECTION 3 OF 4

Do I Qualify? — Self-Check Checklist

Run through these to see where you stand. This is a general guide — exact qualification requires a full application review.

TSAHC Home Sweet Texas — Quick Check

- ☐ Household income below $167,250? (Travis County limit)
- ☐ Target purchase price below $593,000?
- ☐ Credit score 620 or above?
- ☐ Buying a primary residence (not investment property)?

✓ 4 of 4? You're likely eligible for TSAHC — up to 5% grant with zero repayment.

The 3 Biggest DPA Myths — Busted

✗ MYTH

"DPA means a second monthly payment on top of my mortgage."

✓ TRUTH

TSAHC grants require zero repayment — ever. TDHCA and Travis County programs are 0% interest with no monthly payment required. The only condition on forgivable programs is staying in the home through the forgiveness period.

✗ MYTH

"I make too much money to qualify."

✓ TRUTH

TSAHC's Travis County income limit is $167,250 — covering the vast majority of Austin households. Buyers earning $80K–$140K are exactly who this program was designed for.

✗ MYTH

"I need perfect credit."

✓ TRUTH

TSAHC and TDHCA minimums are 620. Travis County requires 640. If you're 620+, you're in range. Below 620? A 3–6 month improvement plan is usually enough.

SECTION 4 OF 4

Your Next Steps

If you checked most boxes in Section 3, you're closer than you think. Here's the path from here to closing day.

1. **Check your credit score.** Pull a free score from Credit Karma or AnnualCreditReport.com. 620+ means you're eligible today. Below 620? We build a plan — typically 3–6 months.
2. **Know your income and price target.** Have a rough sense of your household gross income and the price range you're targeting. That's enough for a DPA scenario review.
3. **Book a free 15-minute DPA review.** I'll run your numbers through every active program and show you exactly what you'd receive, what your payment would look like, and what cash you'd need. No credit pull. No obligation.
4. **Get pre-approved.** If the numbers work, a full pre-approval takes 15–20 minutes online. DPA is applied during the loan process — nothing extra required from you at this stage.

Book Your Free 15-Minute DPA Review

I'll run your scenario and tell you exactly which programs you qualify for, how much you'd receive, and what your monthly payment would look like. 15 minutes. No credit pull. No pressure.

Schedule: calendly.com/adamstyer/15minutes
Contact Adam: styermortgage.com/contact.html

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Adam is licensed in Texas. This is not an offer to lend. All loans subject to underwriting approval and credit qualification. DPA program availability and terms are subject to change — verify current limits with program administrators before applying. TSAHC: tsahc.org · TDHCA: welcomehome.tdhca.texas.gov · City of Austin: austintexas.gov · Travis County: corporations.traviscountytx.gov